THE VERIFIED-REVENUE MARKET · 2026

Buying Revenue, Not Stories

An investment thesis for the micro-SaaS acquisition market — where 1,000 payment-verified businesses reveal that scale, not category, is the only signal that pays.

Strategy & Capital Deployment Review

$134M
Verified annual revenue

1,000
Payment-verified businesses

$87M
Live asking value

18
Assets that clear our screen

THE MARKET

Solo founders now run real businesses — and for the first time, we can verify it

A new asset class of small, cash-generating software companies has become underwritable.

1 What it is

A public register of independent software businesses that connect their payment processor directly — Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle — so reported revenue is machine-verified, not self-claimed.

2 Who builds here

Solo founders and two-person teams across 65 countries, monetising through subscriptions, in-app purchases and usage fees. Cost bases are minimal; margins are structurally high.

3 Why it matters to us

262 of these businesses are openly for sale with published asking prices. That is a liquid, transparent, sub-$1M deal market with no broker layer and no financial statements to audit.

65

countries represented

29

product categories

$282

median monthly revenue

26%

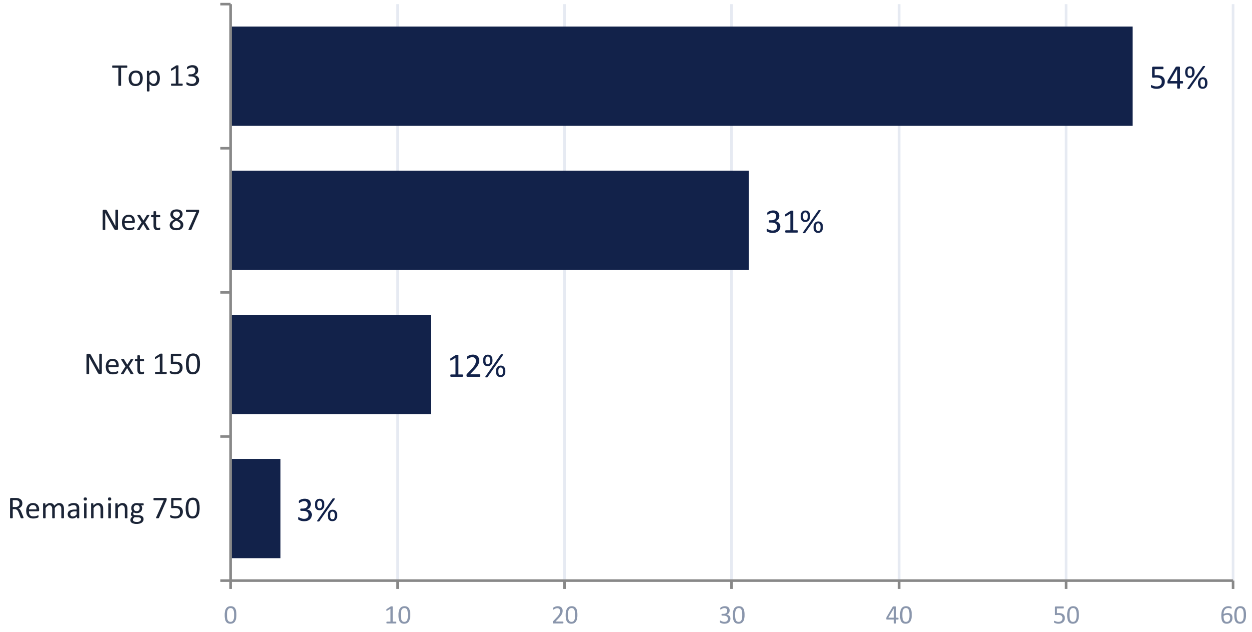
of businesses are for sale

Base: 1,000 payment-verified businesses, revenue frozen 30 July 2026.

MARKET STRUCTURE

This is not a market of 1,000 businesses. It is a market of about 150.

Thirteen companies produce more revenue than the other 987 combined.



Share of $134M annual market revenue

What the long tail actually is

629 businesses earn under $12,000 a year — below minimum wage in every market they operate in.

109 have never processed a single dollar of revenue.

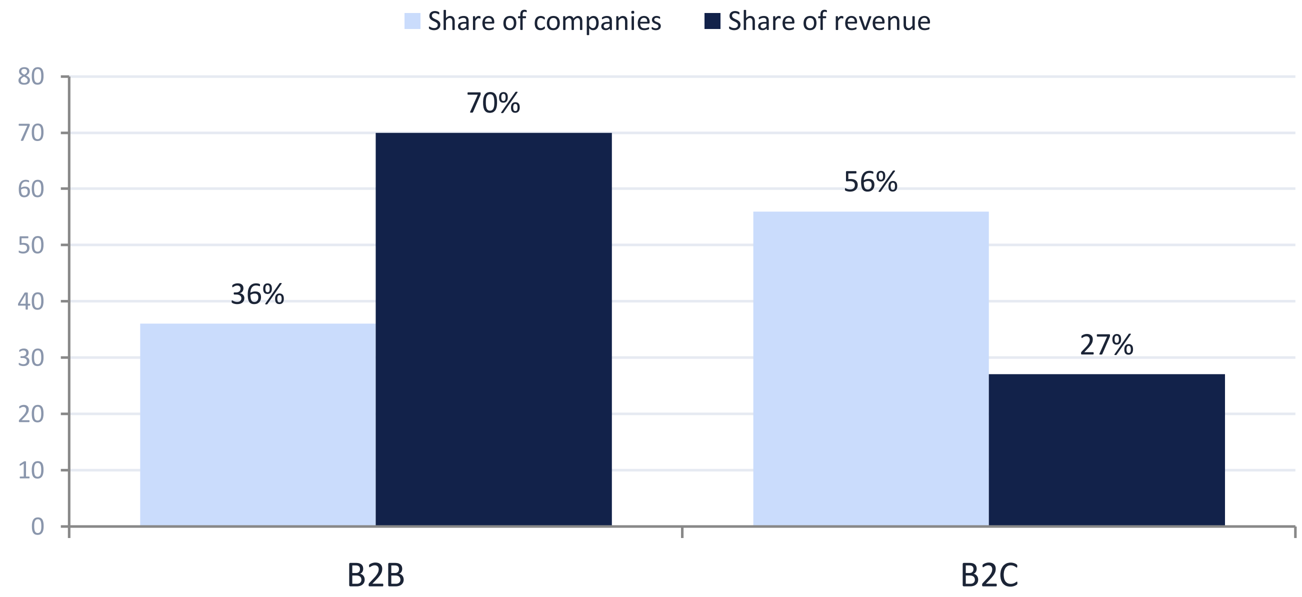
0.05% of market revenue comes from the 395 businesses earning under $1,000 a year.

Implication: screening on category or listing count is meaningless. Only the top decile is investable.

DEMAND SIDE

Selling to businesses is worth roughly four times selling to consumers

B2B is a third of the companies and more than two-thirds of the revenue.



3.8x

The median B2B business earns $8,362 a year against $2,213 for the median consumer app.

Why the gap persists

Both segments carry a near-identical subscriber count at the median — 16 for B2B against 19 for B2C. The difference is price per customer, not reach. Consumer businesses are not smaller; they are cheaper.

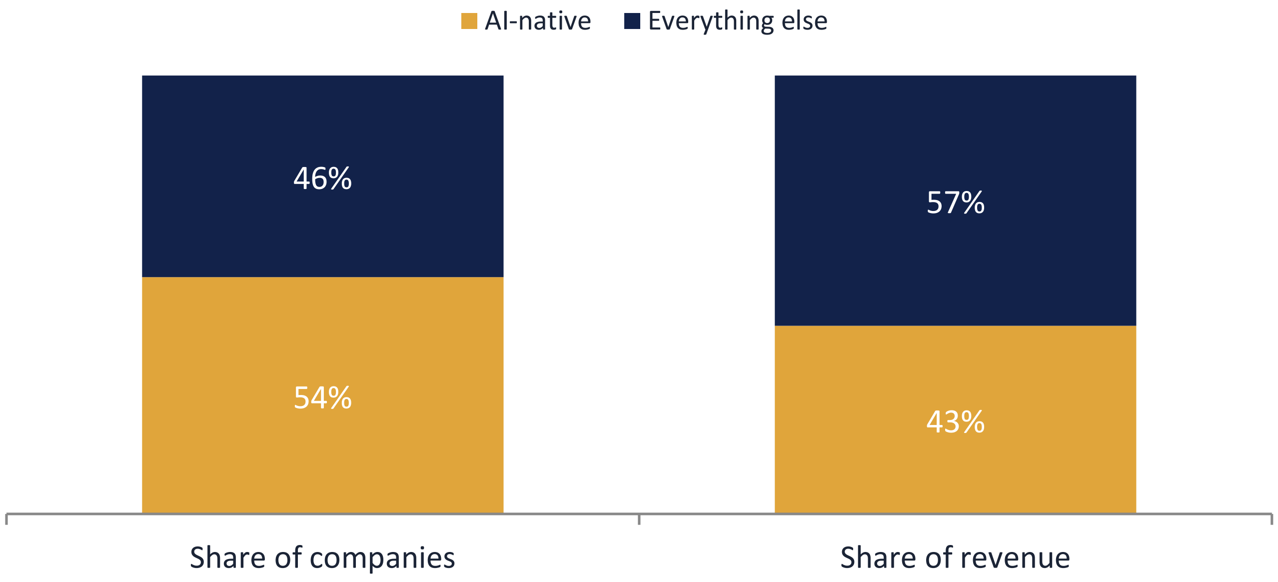
Implication: acquire pricing power, not user counts. A consumer asset needs four times the audience to match a B2B asset.

Shares of the 712 businesses with a classified audience type; the balance sells to both.

SUPPLY SIDE

AI is where founders are building. It is not where the money is.

The most crowded category in the market under-earns its share of companies.



The crowding penalty

- 197 businesses classify themselves primarily as AI — three times the next largest category.
- They generate $94k of revenue per company. Marketing tools generate $349k and e-commerce tools $633k.
- 31% of AI businesses are already listed for sale, against a 26% market average.

AI is a feature attached to a business model — it is not one.

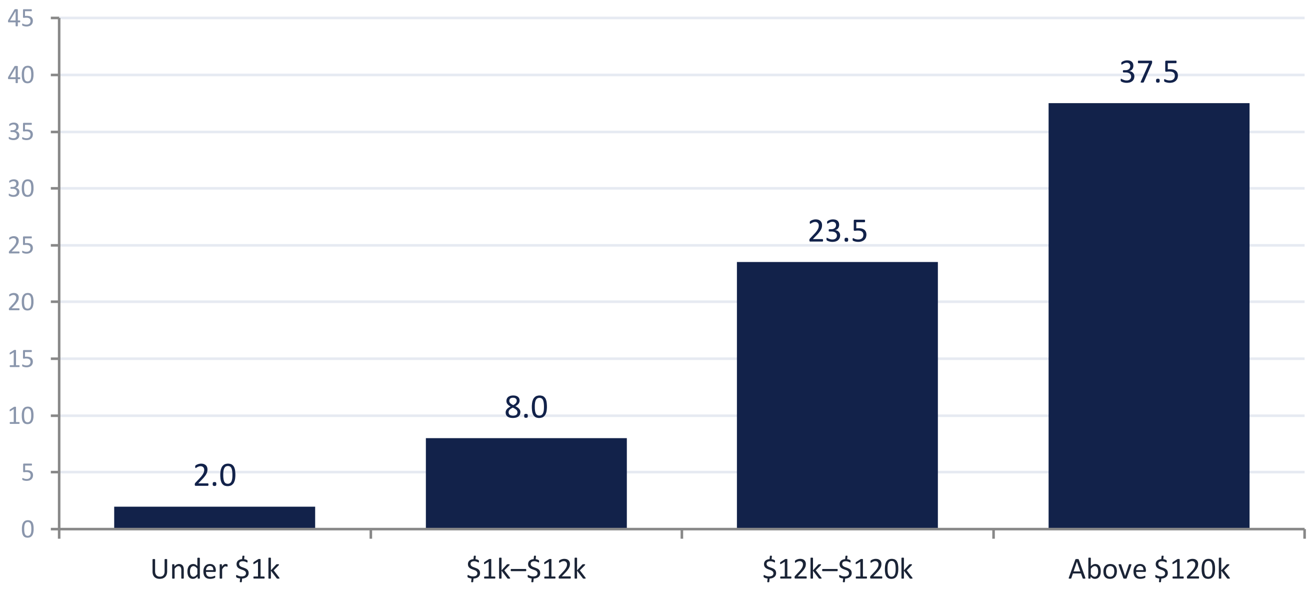
Implication: treat an AI label as neutral at best. Underwrite the underlying workflow and the buyer who pays for it.

Based on the 726 businesses carrying a classified category or market tag.

THE REAL MOAT

Search authority predicts revenue. Social following does not.

The one durable asset in a market with no technology moat is owned distribution.



Median domain authority by annual revenue band

0.57 Correlation between domain authority and revenue — the strongest external signal in the market.

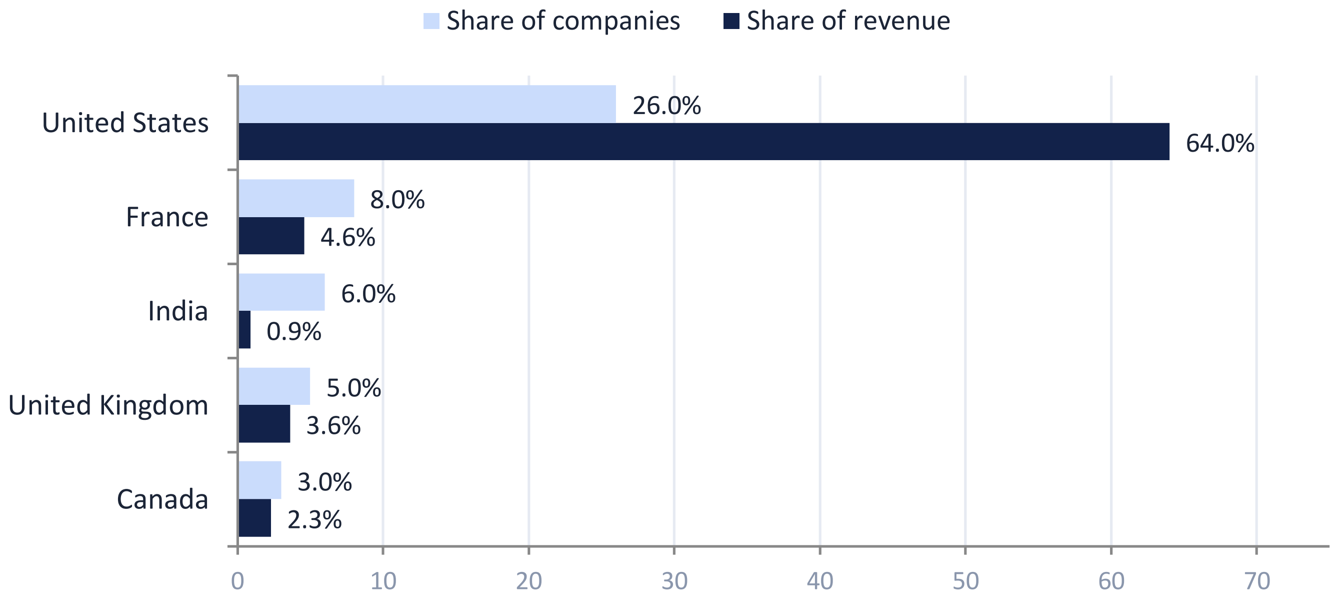
0.21 Correlation between founder social following and revenue — effectively noise.

Implication: domain authority is the cheapest pre-diligence filter available, and the hardest asset for a seller to fake or a rival to rebuild.

GEOGRAPHY

Building is global. Monetising is still American.

A quarter of the businesses capture two-thirds of the revenue — and they sit in one market.



The monetisation gap

- A US business averages $330k of annual revenue. An Indian business averages $20k — and its median is $98.
- France places 79 businesses in the market, the second-highest count, for 4.6% of revenue.
- The constraint is customer willingness to pay, not builder quality. The same product sold to a US buyer earns multiples more.

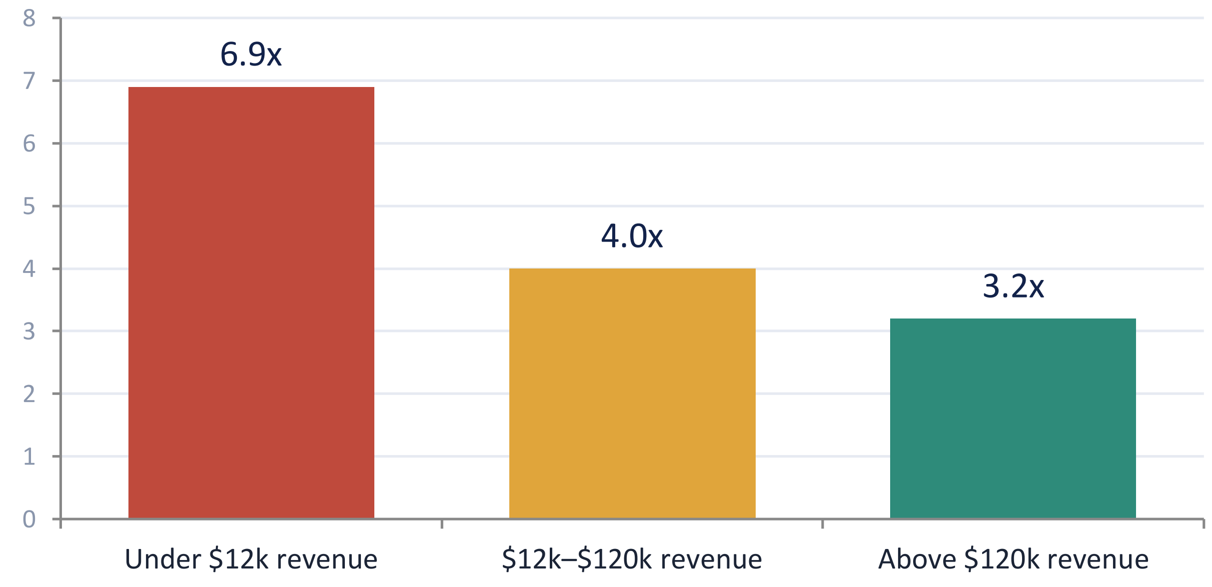
Implication: buy where the customers are, not where the founder is. A low-cost team serving US customers is the mispriced pocket.

Company shares of 1,000; revenue shares of $134M. 759 businesses disclose a home country.

THE MISPRICING

The market charges the highest multiples for the weakest assets

Multiples fall as quality rises — the exact inverse of every mature private market.



Asking price as a multiple of verified annual revenue

Where the premium is unjustified

Health & Fitness	11.7x
Mobile Apps	7.5x
AI tools	5.0x
SaaS	3.2x
E-commerce tools	3.0x

Consumer categories with the weakest retention carry the richest asks. Durable B2B software is the cheapest thing on the shelf.

Implication: sellers price on narrative; the market rewards buyers who price on durability. Discipline alone is the edge.

243 listings carrying both a published asking price and verified revenue.

WHERE TO DEPLOY

Four filters reduce 1,000 listings to 18 investable assets

A disciplined screen turns an unmanageable market into a concentrated, underwritable portfolio.

1,000	>	262	>	73	>	30	>	18
Verified businesses		**Openly for sale**		**Above $50k revenue**		**Domain authority 20+**		**Priced under 4x**
Full market		$87M asking value		Real cash generation		Durable distribution		The deployable set

$11.0M	$5.2M	2.1x	4.8x
Total capital required	Annual revenue acquired	Blended entry multiple	Market median asking multiple

The screened set clears at less than half the market's median asking multiple — because the filters remove exactly the assets buyers overpay for.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Buy scale and distribution. Ignore the story.

1	**Concentrate, do not diversify**	Deploy $11M across the 18 screened assets rather than spreading capital over the long tail. Below $50k of annual revenue these are projects, not businesses — and they are priced at more than double the multiple.
2	**Pay for buyers, not builders**	Weight the portfolio toward B2B assets serving US customers. They monetise roughly four times better per subscriber, and that pricing power survives a change of owner.
3	**Underwrite distribution, not technology**	Make domain authority above 20 a hard gate. It is the only variable here that both predicts revenue and cannot be rebuilt quickly by a competitor.
4	**Refuse the category premium**	Decline Health & Fitness and mobile consumer apps at current asks of 7–12x. The same capital buys durable B2B software at 3x.

The market's inefficiency is that it prices narrative. Ours is a discipline strategy, not a discovery strategy.